



AFRICAN MONTESSORI HUB

LEADACY PROGRAMME GUIDEBOOK

A Montessori-Grounded Leadership, Diplomacy & Global Citizenship
Journey for Children and Young People

— I AM BECAUSE WE ARE

African Montessori Hub · LEADacy Programme

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DEAR LEADACY LEARNER,

WELCOME TO LEADACY.

I hope that as you begin this journey, you give yourself permission to be curious, to ask questions, to explore ideas, to challenge what you think you know, and to discover new things about yourself along the way.

LeadAcy was created with a simple belief: young people have something meaningful to contribute to the world right now. You do not have to wait until you are older to have important ideas, to care about your community, or to make a difference.

Over the course of this journey, you will explore questions that reach beyond the classroom. You will think about who you are, where you come from, the communities you belong to and the world you are part of. You will encounter different perspectives, engage with real issues, work with others, use your voice and have opportunities to turn your ideas into action.

SOME OF THE QUESTIONS YOU ENCOUNTER MAY NOT HAVE EASY ANSWERS. THAT IS INTENTIONAL.

Learning to lead also means learning to listen. It means being comfortable with not knowing, being willing to change your mind when you learn something new, and understanding that people can see the same world differently. It means learning how to disagree with respect, how to work through challenges with others, and how to take responsibility for the choices you make.

I also hope this journey helps you see your identity as a strength. Your story, your culture, your community and your experiences all shape the way you see the world. Bring them with you. There is value in knowing where you come from while remaining open to where you can go.



YOUR PLACE IS ALREADY HERE

LEADACY LEARNERS, ZIMBABWE

At African Montessori Hub, we often return to the words “I am because we are.” They remind us that who we become is connected to the people and world around us. As you grow in confidence and understanding, I hope you also grow in your sense of responsibility to others.

And as you move through these pages, remember that this is not a journey you have to get perfect. There will be moments when you have a great idea, moments when you are unsure, moments when you disagree, and moments when you surprise yourself. All of them belong here.

As someone who has the privilege of helping shape this programme, my greatest hope is that you finish LeadAcy with more than knowledge. I hope you leave with a stronger sense of who you are, what you care about, what you are capable of, and how you can contribute.

SO, AS YOU GO

01 ASK THE DIFFICULT QUESTION.

02 SHARE THE IDEA THAT YOU ARE NOT SURE ABOUT.

03 LISTEN TO SOMEONE WHOSE EXPERIENCE IS DIFFERENT FROM YOURS.

04 IMAGINE SOMETHING THAT DOES NOT EXIST YET.

AND WHEN YOU SEE SOMETHING THAT COULD BE BETTER, ASK YOURSELF

WHAT CAN I DO ABOUT IT?

You already have a place in this world. LeadAcy is an invitation to understand that place and begin discovering what you can do with it.

WELCOME TO THE JOURNEY.

WITH WARMTH,

ROPAFADZO MAZARIRE

PROGRAMS DIRECTOR

AFRICAN MONTESSORI HUB

I AM BECAUSE WE ARE.



1 ABOUT LEADACY

LEADacy is an African Montessori Hub programme designed to develop confident, ethical, innovative and globally minded young people who are deeply rooted in their identity, culture and communities.

The programme brings together Montessori-informed learning, leadership development, diplomacy, public voice, civic responsibility, African consciousness and global citizenship. It is designed around active participation: children explore, question, communicate, collaborate, make decisions and take action.

LEADacy is designed to operate through school-based clubs and other youth settings. AMH's programme framework positions LEADacy as a pathway for leadership, diplomacy, public speaking, critical thinking, innovation, civic engagement, entrepreneurship and African consciousness.

This guidebook translates that vision into a practical learning journey. It is deliberately flexible: sessions can be combined, extended or revisited depending on whether LEADacy is delivered through an 8-week out-of-school cycle, a 12-week in-school cycle, or an ongoing club programme.

WHAT LEADACY SEEKS TO DEVELOP

- Self-awareness and confidence.
- Communication and public voice.
- Respectful dialogue, debate and decision-making.
- Appreciation of African identity, culture and heritage.
- Global awareness and responsible citizenship.
- Leadership and responsibility.
- Critical thinking, creativity and problem-solving.
- Understanding of rights and responsibilities.
- Diplomacy, negotiation and conflict-resolution skills.
- Collaboration, service and community engagement.

2 THE LEADACY LEARNING PHILOSOPHY

FROM UNDERSTANDING THE WORLD TO LEADING WITHIN IT

GROUNDING IN THE SECOND PLANE

The African Montessori Hub's LEADacy Programme is grounded in a powerful Montessori understanding of the child between approximately six and twelve years old: this is the period when the child moves from simply absorbing the world to actively questioning, interpreting, and finding their place within it. If the First Plane child asks, "What is this?", the Second Plane child increasingly asks, "Why is it this way? Is it fair? How is everything connected? And what can I do about it?" This developmental shift sits at the heart of LEADacy.

A PERIOD OF EXTRAORDINARY DEVELOPMENT

Montessori described the Second Plane as a period of extraordinary intellectual, moral, social, and imaginative development. Children become interested not only in facts but in causes, relationships, human behaviour, belonging, and possibility. Their imagination allows them to travel beyond what they can physically see — to ancient civilisations, distant countries, ecosystems, political systems, scientific discoveries, and possible futures. At the same time, their growing reasoning mind invites them to question the structures and assumptions of the world around them.

LEADERSHIP AS AGENCY, NOT AUTHORITY

LEADacy interprets this developmental moment as an invitation into leadership. Rather than teaching leadership as authority, status, or something reserved for adulthood, LEADacy introduces leadership as agency, responsibility, voice, curiosity, and contribution. Children investigate real questions affecting their communities and the wider world. Through dialogue, research, public speaking, diplomacy, collaborative problem-solving, the Sustainable Development Goals, and community engagement, they are invited to understand the world, and then imagine how they might participate in changing it.

COSMIC EDUCATION MEETS UBUNTU

This is where Montessori's Cosmic Education meets an African understanding of Ubuntu. Cosmic Education tells the child that everything in the universe is interconnected and that every living thing makes a contribution to the whole. Ubuntu deepens that proposition: *I am because we are*. Together, they offer an African Montessori interpretation of leadership in which the child does not ask only, "Who am I?", but also, "Who am I in relationship to others, and what is my responsibility to my community?"

THE PREPARED ENVIRONMENT, AND THE ADULT'S ROLE

LEADacy therefore intentionally creates opportunities for children to explore identity, ancestry, African history, culture, global citizenship, justice, environmental stewardship, diplomacy, community and service. The adult's role is not to prescribe what kind of leader the child should become. Instead, the adult prepares an environment rich enough for children to discover their interests, exercise their voices, encounter different perspectives, make decisions, experience consequences, collaborate with others and increasingly take responsibility for their own learning.

FIRST PLANE

Help me to do it myself.

SECOND PLANE

Help me to understand and think for myself.

LEADACY

Help me understand my world, find my voice, and discover how I can contribute to it.

At AMH, we believe children should not have to wait until adulthood to experience themselves as citizens, thinkers, problem-solvers and leaders. The child is not merely preparing for the future; the child is already a participant in the present. LEADacy exists to make that participation visible, meaningful and powerful.

UNDERSTAND THE WORLD. FIND YOUR VOICE. IMAGINE WHAT IS POSSIBLE. CONTRIBUTE.

THAT IS LEADACY

IN THE WORDS OF

TATENDA BLESSING MUCHIRI

THE LEADACY LEARNING CYCLE

Explore → Experience → Express → Reflect → Apply



The guidebook is a curriculum resource, not a rigid timetable. Sessions are designed as building blocks that can be adapted to different programme cycles while maintaining the overall developmental journey.

EACH SESSION CONTAINS

- Session title and guiding question
- Purpose
- Expected outcomes
- LEADacy connection
- Montessori connection
- Key concepts
- Materials and preparation
- Suggested session flow
- Main activity or activities
- Games and activity alternatives
- Reflection prompts
- Extension or real-world challenge

USING THE SESSIONS FLEXIBLY

A session may be delivered in one sitting, split across two meetings, or combined with another session. The depth should reflect the age of learners, available time and setting. The priority is meaningful exploration rather than completing every activity.

AGE AND CONTEXT

Activities can be simplified for younger learners or made more analytical for older learners. Where resources are limited, everyday objects, stories, local environments and children's own experiences should become learning resources.

The 12 sessions form a developmental journey from the self to the wider world and from awareness to action.

01

Montessori & the Prepared Leader — How do we learn, lead and live together?

02

Who Am I? — Who am I beyond what people see?

03

Grooming & Etiquette — How do I present myself, care for myself and show respect to others?

04

Me & My Environment — What has shaped me, and what role do I play in my community?

05

Rights & Responsibilities — What are my rights, and what responsibilities come with them?

06

Culture, Tradition & Belonging — Where do I come from, and what does belonging mean?

07

The World From a Glance — Who else is in our world, and how are we connected?

08

Diplomacy & Influencing Decisions — How can I communicate, negotiate and influence peacefully?

09

Public Speaking as an Art — How can I use my voice with confidence and purpose?

10

Global Issues & My Role in the World — What challenges face our world, and what can I contribute?

11

The Art of Debate & Decision-Making — How do we disagree, reason and make decisions together?

12

Research, Teamwork & MMUN — Can I work with others to represent, negotiate and act?

FROM THE SELF TO THE WIDER WORLD

THE TWELVE SESSIONS

Montessori & the Prepared Leader

Who Am I?

Grooming & Etiquette

Me & My Environment

Rights & Responsibilities

Culture, Tradition & Belonging

The World From a Glance

Diplomacy & Influencing Decisions

Public Speaking as an Art

Global Issues & My Role in the World

The Art of Debate & Decision-Making

Research, Teamwork & MMUN



PURPOSE

Introduce learners to the Montessori approach and connect its principles to everyday leadership, responsibility and relationships.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Explain basic Montessori principles in child-friendly language.
- Demonstrate independence, responsibility and respect in a shared environment.
- Identify how choice and responsibility are connected.
- Recognise that leadership begins with how we manage ourselves and relate to others.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Builds self-leadership, responsibility, respect and purposeful action.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Introduces the prepared environment, independence, choice within limits, order, concentration and learning through experience.

KEY CONCEPTS

Montessori

Prepared environment

Independence

Choice

Responsibility

Respect

Leadership



MATERIALS

- Simple classroom or community objects
- Paper and drawing materials
- Labels/cards
- Open space for movement

PREPARATION

- Prepare a calm, orderly environment.
- Place materials where learners can access them independently.
- Begin with a short observation or practical demonstration rather than a lecture.

KEY QUESTIONS

What makes an environment help us learn? · What does freedom mean if we also have responsibilities? · How can someone lead without being in charge?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — THE PREPARED ENVIRONMENT

Learners observe the space, identify what helps or interrupts concentration, and work together to improve one part of it.

LEADERSHIP GAME — LEAD WITHOUT A TITLE

In small groups, learners complete a simple task where no formal leader is appointed. Reflect on how leadership emerges.

REFLECTION

What did I choose? What did I take responsibility for? How did my actions affect others?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Invite learners to identify one way they can make their home, classroom or club environment more orderly, respectful or welcoming.



**PURPOSE**

Explore personal identity, strengths, interests, values, feelings, dreams and the qualities each learner brings to a community.

**EXPECTED OUTCOMES**

- Identify personal strengths, interests and aspirations.
- Express aspects of identity creatively.
- Recognise similarities and differences between people without ranking them.
- Describe at least one quality they want to develop.

**LEADACY CONNECTION**

Builds self-awareness, confidence, agency and the foundation for authentic leadership.

**MONTESSORI CONNECTION**

Supports self-directed exploration, child voice, observation and recognition of the whole person.

**KEY CONCEPTS**

Identity

Strengths

Values

Interests

Aspirations

Uniqueness



SESSION 02 · CONTINUED

MATERIALS

- Large paper
- Markers/crayons
- Magazines or safe images if available
- String or sticky notes

PREPARATION

- Create individual working space.
- Prepare body-mapping or identity-poster materials.
- Avoid forcing children to disclose sensitive personal information.

KEY QUESTIONS

What makes you you? · What are you good at? · What matters to you? · What would you like to become better at?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — MY IDENTITY MAP

Learners create a visual map of themselves using words, symbols, drawings and images.

BODY MAPPING / IDENTITY POSTER

Learners associate strengths, feelings, abilities or hopes with different parts of a drawn body, then create a visual identity poster.

REFLECTION

Which part of my identity am I proud of? Which part do I want to grow?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Create a personal leadership strength card that can be revisited later in the programme.



PURPOSE

This session introduces personal grooming, self-presentation and social etiquette as elements of confidence, dignity and respectful leadership. Learners explore how appearance, hygiene, manners, body language and consideration for others influence how we move through different environments.

The emphasis should not be on expensive clothing, beauty standards or judging appearance. The focus is on cleanliness, self-care, appropriateness, confidence, respect and knowing how to conduct oneself in different social settings.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

By the end of the session, learners should be able to:

- Explain why personal hygiene and grooming matter.
- Identify basic personal grooming practices.
- Demonstrate appropriate etiquette in different settings.
- Recognise how body language and manners communicate respect.
- Distinguish between appropriate and inappropriate behaviour in social situations.
- Present themselves with confidence while respecting others.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Develops self-leadership, confidence, social awareness, professionalism and respectful interaction—essential qualities for young leaders and diplomats.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Encourages independence, care of self, order, grace and courtesy, with learners practising real-life skills through purposeful activity rather than simply being told what to do.

KEY CONCEPTS

Grooming

Hygiene

Self-care

Grace & Courtesy

Etiquette

Respect

Confidence

Presentation

Body Language



MATERIALS

- Mirror or small hand mirrors
- Comb/brush
- Clean cloth or handkerchief
- Toothbrush/toothpaste demonstration items
- Soap/handwashing materials
- Simple grooming checklist
- Scenario cards
- Optional clothing/accessory examples
- Paper and markers

PREPARATION

- Create a clean, welcoming space where learners can practise without embarrassment.
- Prepare different social scenarios: school, interview, formal event, meeting, visiting someone, eating with others, public transport, etc.
- Avoid activities that shame children about their bodies, clothing, hair or family circumstances.
- Emphasise that good grooming is about care and dignity, not wealth or appearance.

KEY QUESTIONS

What does it mean to take care of yourself? · What is the difference between grooming and trying to impress people? · Why do manners matter? · Does etiquette look the same in every culture? · How should a leader behave when nobody important is watching? · How can we make other people feel respected?

ACTIVITIES

1 — THE GROOMING DETECTIVE

Give learners a series of everyday situations and ask them to identify what personal-care habits might be appropriate. For example: *"You are going to school after playing football."* · *"You are attending a formal meeting."* · *"You have just eaten lunch."* · *"You are travelling with other people."* Learners identify appropriate actions such as washing hands, freshening up, arranging clothing, brushing teeth, covering a cough, disposing of rubbish appropriately or checking their appearance.

Key lesson: Grooming is preparation for participating confidently in shared spaces.

2 — GRACE & COURTESY ROLE PLAY

Pairs or small groups receive a scenario and demonstrate the appropriate behaviour. Possible scenarios: greeting an elder · meeting someone for the first time · introducing yourself · asking for help · entering a room · joining a conversation · disagreeing respectfully · receiving a compliment · apologising · thanking someone · speaking to someone who is different from you · eating with others · leaving a shared space.

After each performance, ask: What showed respect? What could be improved?

3 — THE FIRST IMPRESSION CHALLENGE

One learner enters the room and introduces themselves as though they are meeting someone for the first time. The group observes: posture · facial expression · eye contact · greeting · voice · listening · personal space · confidence. Repeat the exercise after learners receive feedback.

The point is not to create a "perfect" personality. It is to demonstrate that small behaviours influence how people experience us.



4 — WHAT'S APPROPRIATE?

Place scenario cards around the room. Learners decide whether the behaviour is **Appropriate**, **Needs Adjustment** or **Disrespectful**. Examples: talking loudly while someone else is speaking · looking at your phone during a meeting · greeting someone politely · interrupting someone · helping an elderly person · laughing when someone makes a mistake · asking before using someone's belongings · leaving rubbish behind · saying "please" and "thank you" · correcting someone publicly in a humiliating way.

Discuss the reasoning rather than simply looking for the "correct" answer.

5 — THE LEADER'S MIRROR

Give each learner a mirror and ask: *"When I look in this mirror, what kind of leader do I want people to meet?"* Learners write or draw three qualities they want to communicate through their behaviour — for example: respectful · confident · kind · responsible · calm · prepared · welcoming.

This connects external presentation to internal character.

OPTIONAL MONTESSORI PRACTICAL-LIFE ACTIVITY

PREPARING MYSELF FOR THE DAY

Create a practical-life station where learners practise sequencing a simple preparation routine:

Wash → Groom → Dress appropriately → Check appearance → Prepare belongings →
Enter the environment respectfully

Older learners can develop their own "Ready to Lead" morning routine. Younger learners can use picture cards to arrange the sequence independently.

REFLECTION

What does good grooming say about how I care for myself? · What does good etiquette say about how I care for other people? · Which habit do I already practise well? · Which habit would I like to improve? · How can I show respect without saying a word? · Does being well-groomed mean being expensive or fashionable? Why not? · What does "grace and courtesy" mean to me?

→ TAKE IT FURTHER

THE 7-DAY GRACE & COURTESY CHALLENGE

Learners choose one habit to practise for seven days: greeting people respectfully · saying please and thank you · keeping personal spaces tidy · listening without interrupting · maintaining personal hygiene · being punctual/prepared · helping others without being asked.

At the next LEADacy meeting, learners share what they noticed, not whether they were "perfect."



**PURPOSE**

Help learners understand that people are shaped by families, schools, communities, environments, opportunities and challenges—and can also influence those environments.

**EXPECTED OUTCOMES**

- Identify people, places and experiences that shape their lives.
- Map strengths and challenges in their community.
- Recognise that environments can support or limit people.
- Identify one issue they would like to improve.

**LEADACY CONNECTION**

Develops systems awareness, community leadership, problem-solving and responsibility.

**MONTESSORI CONNECTION**

Connects the child to the prepared environment and the Montessori principle of care for self, others and the environment.

**KEY CONCEPTS**

Environment

Community

Belonging

Influence

Problem-solving

Service



MATERIALS

- Paper
- Markers
- Local maps or hand-drawn maps
- Stickers/sticky notes

KEY QUESTIONS

What places make you feel safe and welcome? · What problems do people experience here? · Who has the power to change things? · What can children influence?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — COMMUNITY MAP

Learners create a map showing people, places, resources, challenges and opportunities.

COMMUNITY DETECTIVE / PROBLEM TREE

Learners observe their environment, identify one issue, and explore its causes and effects.

REFLECTION

What does my environment teach me? What can I do to improve it?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Choose one small, realistic improvement that learners could support through a future service or innovation project.



PURPOSE

Introduce children to rights, responsibilities, fairness and peaceful coexistence using child-friendly examples and relevant rights frameworks.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Name selected children's rights in accessible language.
- Distinguish between a right and a responsibility.
- Identify situations where rights may be respected or violated.
- Suggest peaceful and fair responses to rights-related problems.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Builds civic awareness, ethical leadership, justice, participation and responsibility.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Encourages respect for human dignity, independent thinking, dialogue and responsibility toward others.

KEY CONCEPTS

Rights

Responsibilities

Dignity

Fairness

Participation

Peace



MATERIALS

- Rights cards
- Scenario cards
- Large paper
- Markers
- Optional extracts of UNCRC and African Charter provisions

KEY QUESTIONS

What is a right? · Why do rights exist? · Who is responsible for protecting rights? · Can people have rights and responsibilities at the same time?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — RIGHTS IN ACTION

Groups receive scenarios and identify the rights involved, responsibilities of different actors and possible solutions.

RIGHTS CORNERS / PEACEFUL SOLUTIONS

Learners respond to statements, then transform a conflict scenario into a fair, peaceful outcome.

REFLECTION

What responsibility do I have when another person's rights are affected?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Create a simple rights and responsibilities charter for the club or class.



PURPOSE

Explore cultural identity, traditions, language, stories, beliefs and practices while developing respect for diversity.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Identify elements of their own cultural identity.
- Explain why traditions and stories matter.
- Recognise that cultures can contain both similarities and differences.
- Show respect when learning about cultures different from their own.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Strengthens African identity, belonging, cultural confidence and intercultural competence.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Honours the child's lived environment, community knowledge, cultural experience and connection to others.

KEY CONCEPTS

Culture

Tradition

Heritage

Belonging

Identity

Diversity



MATERIALS

- Objects or photographs where available
- Paper
- Drawing materials
- Story prompts
- Optional family/community contributions

KEY QUESTIONS

What traditions do you know? · Who taught you them? · What should we preserve? · Can traditions change?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — MY HERITAGE BOX

Learners draw, describe or present objects, stories or practices that represent their heritage.

STORY CIRCLE / CULTURAL EXCHANGE

Share a family or community story, then compare traditions and identify common human values.

REFLECTION

What part of my heritage would I like future generations to know?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Create a collective cultural exhibition or storytelling event.



PURPOSE

Expand learners' understanding from their community to Africa and the wider world, exploring countries, cultures, religions, identities and interdependence.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Locate or identify selected African and global countries.
- Recognise that people have diverse cultures, languages, religions and identities.
- Identify ways countries and communities are connected.
- Position Africa as an active and diverse part of the global community.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Builds global awareness, cultural literacy, curiosity and respect for difference.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Extends the child's understanding from the immediate environment toward the wider human and natural environment.

KEY CONCEPTS

World

Africa

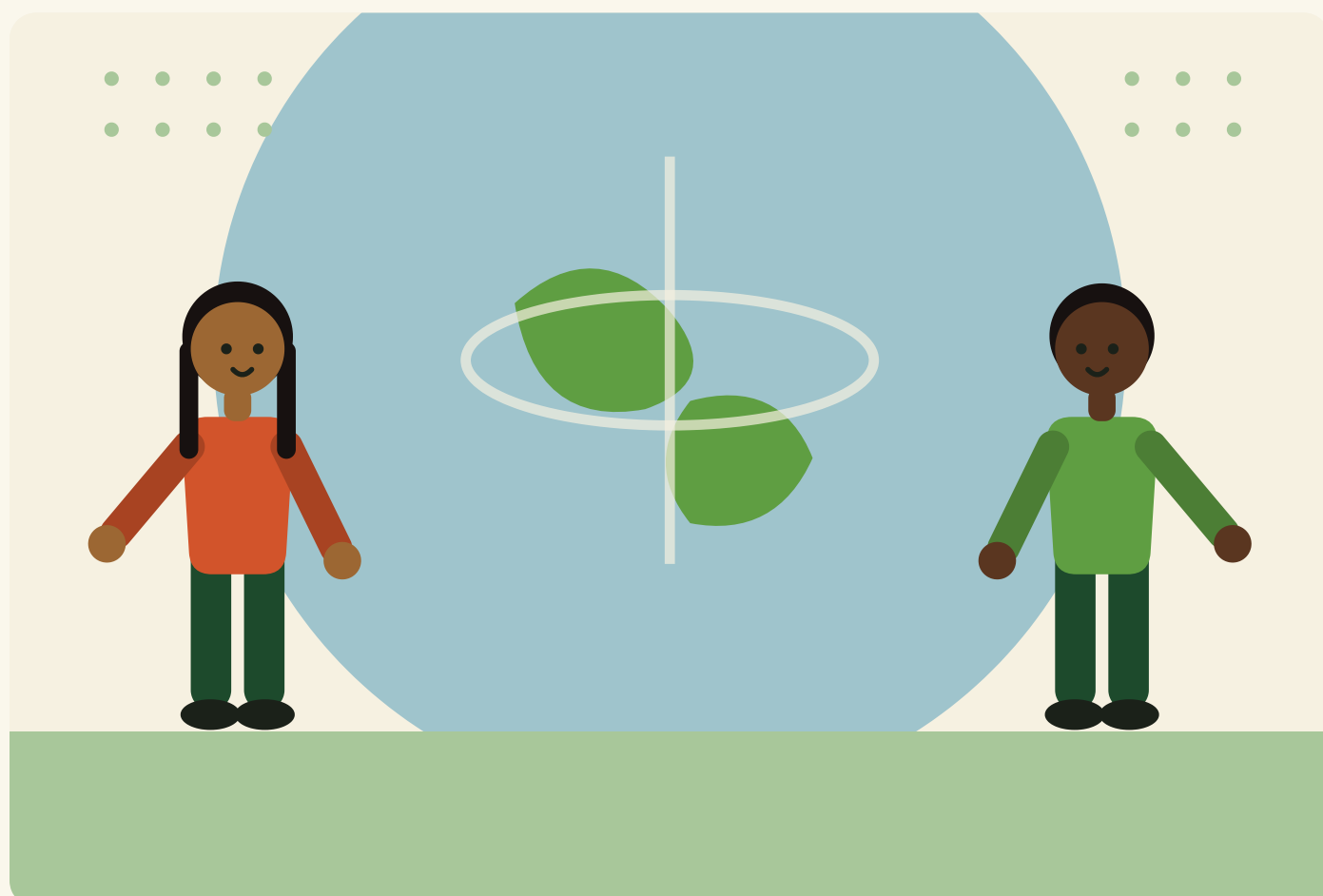
Countries

Culture

Religion

Interdependence

Global citizenship



MATERIALS

- World map or globe
- Country/culture cards
- String
- Images or printed resources
- Sticky notes

KEY QUESTIONS

How many different ways do people live? · What connects countries? · What makes Africa diverse? · What can we learn from people who are different from us?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — OUR CONNECTED WORLD

Learners place countries or communities on a map and draw connections through food, language, trade, migration, sport, music, environment or knowledge.

CULTURE WITHOUT BORDERS

Groups explore a country or culture and identify what they can learn without reducing it to stereotypes.

REFLECTION

What surprised me about the world?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Choose a country that will later become a research or MMUN focus.



**PURPOSE**

Introduce diplomacy as the practice of communicating across differences, representing interests, negotiating and seeking peaceful solutions.

**EXPECTED OUTCOMES**

- Explain diplomacy in child-friendly terms.
- Practise listening and perspective-taking.
- Use negotiation to reach a shared decision.
- Identify respectful ways to influence a decision.

**LEADACY CONNECTION**

Develops negotiation, communication, empathy, representation, conflict resolution and ethical influence.

**MONTESSORI CONNECTION**

Uses respectful dialogue, freedom within limits, collaboration and purposeful problem-solving.

**KEY CONCEPTS**

Diplomacy

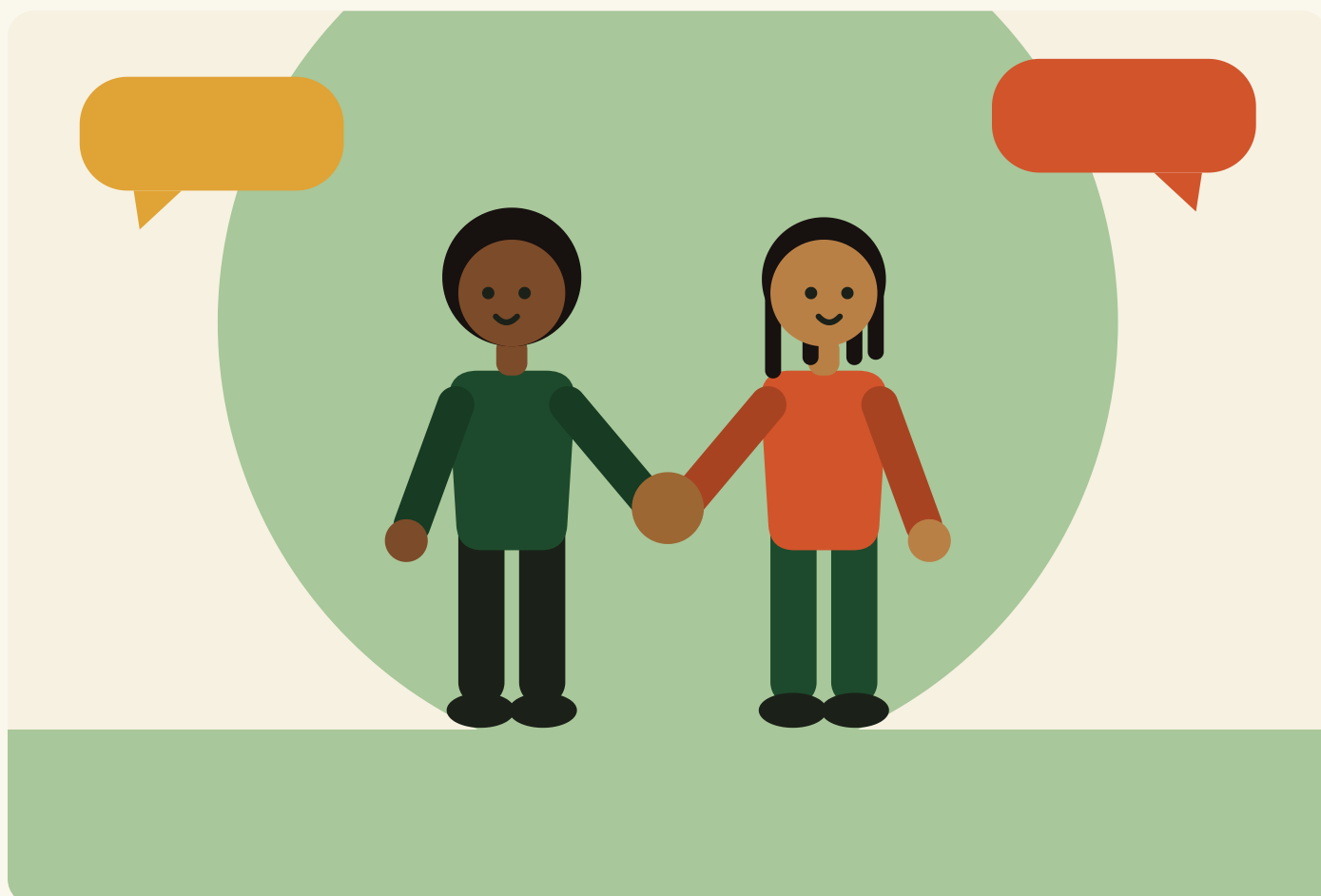
Negotiation

Influence

Representation

Compromise

Conflict resolution



MATERIALS

- Role cards
- Simple negotiation scenarios
- Paper
- Timer

KEY QUESTIONS

What makes someone a good negotiator? · Is compromise always the answer? · How can you influence without forcing someone? · What does it mean to represent someone else?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — THE NEGOTIATION TABLE

Groups receive different interests and must reach a mutually acceptable agreement.

DIPLOMATIC LISTENING / DECISION INFLUENCE CHALLENGE

Learners practise summarising another position before proposing a solution, then make a case for a change they want.

REFLECTION

Did I listen to understand or listen to respond?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Link the negotiation experience to later MMUN country representation and resolution work.



PURPOSE

Develop confidence, presence, storytelling and purposeful communication.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Introduce themselves confidently.
- Use voice, posture and eye contact intentionally.
- Structure a short message or story.
- Speak to an audience with increasing confidence.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Develops public voice, confidence, persuasion and leadership presence.

MONTESSORI CONNECTION

Provides repeated opportunities for purposeful self-expression, choice of topic and learning through practice.

KEY CONCEPTS

Voice

Storytelling

Confidence

Presence

Audience

Persuasion



MATERIALS

- Open speaking space
- Prompt cards
- Timer
- Optional simple objects for storytelling

KEY QUESTIONS

What makes a speaker memorable? · How does your body communicate? · What makes a story powerful?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — ONE-MINUTE STORY

Each learner tells a short story based on a prompt, object, memory or imagined event.

VOICE ORCHESTRA / THREE-MINUTE MESSAGE

Practise volume, pace, pause and tone, then present an idea the learner cares about.

REFLECTION

What changed when I slowed down, projected my voice or made eye contact?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Build a personal speaking portfolio across the programme.



PURPOSE

Connect local experiences to global challenges and help learners see themselves as capable contributors.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Identify selected global issues in age-appropriate language.
- Connect global issues to local realities.
- Explain why different people may experience an issue differently.
- Propose a realistic action or solution.

LEADACY CONNECTION

Develops global citizenship, empathy, innovation, service and social responsibility.

MONTESORI CONNECTION

Connects learning to the wider environment and encourages purposeful, hands-on action.

KEY CONCEPTS

Global issues

SDGs

Climate

Poverty

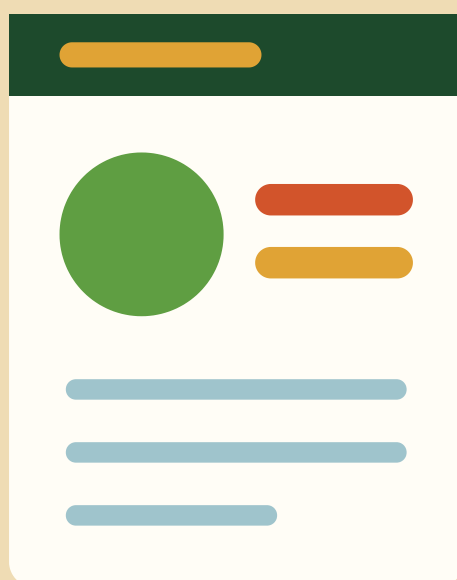
Education

Health

Peace

Innovation

Service



MATERIALS

- SDG cards or posters
- Issue cards
- Paper
- Markers
- Optional local data or stories

KEY QUESTIONS

What is a global issue? · Where do we see it locally? · Who is affected? · What can children realistically do?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — FROM GLOBAL TO LOCAL

Groups choose an issue and trace how it appears globally, nationally and locally.

SOLUTION LAB / SDG MATCH

Groups connect local challenges to relevant SDGs and design a small, realistic response.

REFLECTION

What is one thing I can influence?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Turn one solution into a small service, awareness or innovation project.



**PURPOSE**

Teach learners to express positions, listen to opposing views, use reasons and evidence, and participate in fair decision-making.

**EXPECTED OUTCOMES**

- Distinguish an opinion from a reasoned argument.
- Listen respectfully to an opposing position.
- Use evidence or examples to support a point.
- Participate in a fair group decision.

**LEADACY CONNECTION**

Builds critical thinking, public voice, diplomacy, ethical reasoning and democratic participation.

**MONTESSORI CONNECTION**

Encourages concentration, independent thought, respectful interaction and reflection rather than conformity.

**KEY CONCEPTS**

Debate

Argument

Evidence

Reasoning

Listening

Decision-making



MATERIALS

- Motion cards
- Simple debate rules
- Timer
- Paper

KEY QUESTIONS

Can two people disagree and both remain respectful? · What makes an argument strong? · When should we change our minds? · How should a group make a fair decision?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — FOUR CORNERS DEBATE

Learners position themselves according to their response to a motion, explain why, listen to another position and reconsider.

DECISION CIRCLE / EVIDENCE HUNT

Groups make a shared decision, then identify what information would help them make it better.

REFLECTION

Did I defend an idea or did I defend myself?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Use a debate topic connected to the learners' MMUN issue or community project.



**PURPOSE**

Bring together research, teamwork, public speaking, diplomacy and decision-making through a Model United Nations-style experience.

**EXPECTED OUTCOMES**

- Research a country and understand its position on an issue.
- Work effectively in a team with defined responsibilities.
- Represent a position that may differ from their personal opinion.
- Negotiate with other delegates and contribute to a resolution.

**LEADACY CONNECTION**

Serves as the capstone for leadership, diplomacy, public voice, research and collaboration.

**MONTESSORI CONNECTION**

Combines independent inquiry, purposeful collaboration, communication and hands-on learning.

**KEY CONCEPTS**

Research

Teamwork

Representation

Negotiation

Resolution

MMUN



MATERIALS

- Country profiles
- Issue briefs
- Research materials
- Name cards
- Resolution template
- Placards
- Writing materials

KEY QUESTIONS

What does it mean to represent another country? · How do we know whether information is reliable? · How can countries disagree and still cooperate? · What makes a good resolution?

ACTIVITIES

MAIN ACTIVITY — MINI-MMUN

Teams research, prepare opening statements, negotiate and draft a simple resolution.

COUNTRY DELEGATE CHALLENGE / RESOLUTION LAB

Learners argue from an assigned country's perspective, identify a problem, propose actions and negotiate amendments.

REFLECTION

What did I learn about leadership from working with others?

TAKE IT FURTHER

Use the MMUN simulation or another public showcase as the programme capstone.



The capstone is an opportunity for learners to demonstrate what they have explored rather than sit for a conventional examination. It may take the form of a Mini-MMUN, public speaking showcase, cultural exhibition, debate, community solution pitch, service project presentation or a combination of these.

POSSIBLE CAPSTONE COMPONENTS

- Opening statements or speeches.
- Country or community presentations.
- Structured debate.
- Negotiation or diplomacy simulation.
- Resolution or policy proposal.
- Community problem-solving pitch.
- Cultural exhibition or storytelling.
- Reflection on personal leadership growth.

CAPSTONE REFLECTION

What did I learn about myself?

What did I learn about working with other people?

What did I learn about my community and the wider world?

How did my ideas change?

What would I do differently next time?

What is one action I want to take?

8-WEEK OUT-OF-SCHOOL CYCLE

The 12 sessions can be clustered into eight programme weeks. This is a suggested pathway, not a fixed timetable.

WEEK 1

Montessori & the Prepared Leader + Who Am I?

WEEK 2

Grooming & Etiquette + Me & My Environment

WEEK 3

Rights & Responsibilities + Culture, Tradition & Belonging

WEEK 4

The World From a Glance

WEEK 5

Diplomacy & Influencing Decisions

WEEK 6

Public Speaking as an Art

WEEK 7

Global Issues + Debate & Decision-Making

WEEK 8

Research, Teamwork & MMUN + Capstone

12-WEEK IN-SCHOOL CYCLE

WK 1

Montessori & the Prepared Leader

WK 2

Who Am I?

WK 3

Grooming & Etiquette

WK 4

Me & My Environment

WK 5

Rights & Responsibilities

WK 6

Culture, Tradition & Belonging

WK 7

The World From a Glance

WK 8

Diplomacy & Influencing Decisions

WK 9

Public Speaking as an Art

WK 10

Global Issues & My Role in the World

WK 11

The Art of Debate & Decision-Making

WK 12

Research, Teamwork & MMUN + Showcase

Because LEADacy clubs may meet weekly or bi-weekly, 'week' refers to the programme cycle rather than five daily lessons. Sessions may therefore be split, combined or extended.

The activity bank gives sessions flexibility. Activities can be reused when they serve a different learning purpose.

IDENTITY & SELF

Body Mapping • Identity Poster • My Strengths Card
• Personal Timeline • Values Line • Who Am I? Story

ENVIRONMENT & COMMUNITY

Community Mapping • Community Detective •
Problem Tree • Asset Mapping • Care for the
Environment Challenge

RIGHTS & CITIZENSHIP

Rights Corners • Rights in Action • Scenario Cards •
Rights Charter • Peaceful Solutions

CULTURE & BELONGING

Heritage Box • Story Circle • Cultural Object
Investigation • Language Exchange • Cultural
Exhibition

WORLD & GLOBAL AWARENESS

Map Connections • Country Cards • Culture
Exchange • Global Connections Web • Africa in the
World

DIPLOMACY

Negotiation Table • Perspective Switch • Listening
Challenge • Peace Agreement • Influence Challenge

PUBLIC VOICE

One-Minute Story • Impromptu Speaking • Voice
Orchestra • Story Object • Three-Minute Message

DEBATE & DECISION-MAKING

Four Corners Debate • Decision Circle • Evidence
Hunt • Fishbowl Debate • Consensus Challenge

RESEARCH & MMUN

Country Research • Issue Brief • Delegate
Preparation • Resolution Lab • Mock Negotiation •
Mini-MMUN

SERVICE & INNOVATION

Solution Lab • Community Challenge • SDG Match •
Design a Response • Action Pitch

LEADacy should give learners opportunities to keep evidence of their journey. The portfolio is not primarily a test record. It is a collection of ideas, reflections, creative work, speeches, research, projects and evidence of growth.

POSSIBLE PORTFOLIO CONTENTS

- Identity map or poster.
- Personal leadership strength card.
- Community map.
- Rights and responsibilities charter.
- Cultural heritage work.
- Global connections map.
- Speech or storytelling piece.
- Debate reflection.
- Research or country profile.
- MMUN resolution.
- Community project or innovation proposal.
- Personal reflection after the capstone.

LEARNER REFLECTION PROMPTS

- I discovered...*
- I became more confident when...*
- I used my voice to...*
- I learned to listen when...*
- I changed my mind about...*
- I helped my team by...*
- I learned about my culture when...*
- I learned about another culture when...*
- A problem I care about is...*
- One action I can take is...*

WHAT GROWTH LOOKS LIKE

Growth in LEADacy may be visible in the learner's willingness to participate, ability to listen, confidence in expressing ideas, capacity to work with others, ability to consider different perspectives, responsibility for choices, curiosity about the world and willingness to turn ideas into action.

APPENDIX – LEADACY SESSION QUICK CARD

For final publication, each session can be presented as a compact visual card containing:

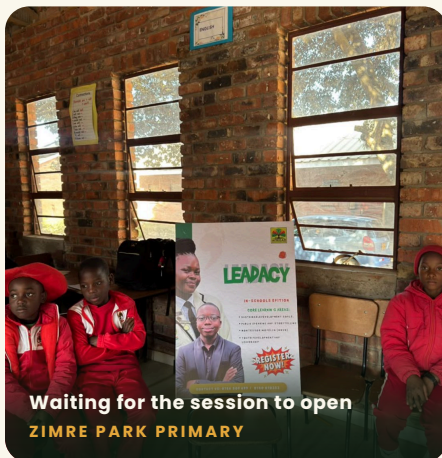
- Session number and title
- Guiding question
- Purpose
- Expected outcomes
- LEADacy connection
- Montessori connection
- Key concepts
- Materials
- Preparation
- Key questions
- Main activity
- Suggested game / alternative activity
- Reflection
- Take it further

SESSIONS IN ACTION

These pages are not theory. Across Zimbabwe, LeadAcy learners are already meeting in classrooms, libraries and committee rooms — asking questions, taking the floor, negotiating with one another and putting their names to ideas about their own communities.

ZIMRE PARK PRIMARY

GWERU — AMERICAN CORNER



THE CHILD IS ALREADY A PARTICIPANT IN THE PRESENT.

I AM BECAUSE WE ARE

REPORTING MECHANISMS & PROTECTION MEASURES

KEEPING EVERY LEADACY PARTICIPANT SAFE



At African Montessori Hub, we believe that every child has the right to dignity, safety, protection and meaningful participation. Safeguarding is therefore not separate from our work — it is an essential part of how LeadAcy is designed and delivered.

LEADACY OPERATES UNDER THE AFRICAN MONTESSORI HUB CHILD PROTECTION AND SAFEGUARDING POLICY AND PROCEDURES MANUAL.

Every LeadAcy activity, interaction and learning environment is expected to uphold AMH's safeguarding standards, with the best interests, safety, dignity and rights of the child at the centre.

AMH recognises that children may experience harm in different settings and through different relationships. LeadAcy therefore takes concerns relating to physical or emotional abuse, sexual abuse and exploitation, neglect, bullying, discrimination, inappropriate conduct, abuse of power, unsafe practices and other forms of harm seriously.

RISKS WE WATCH FOR ACROSS THE PROGRAMME

PROGRAMME ACTIVITIES

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

DIGITAL COMMUNICATION

PHOTOGRAPHY & STORYTELLING

TRANSPORTATION

VISITORS & MENTORS





HOW CAN A CONCERN BE REPORTED?

ANYONE CAN RAISE A SAFEGUARDING CONCERN.

You do not need to investigate or prove that abuse has occurred before reporting it.

A CONCERN MAY BE REPORTED IF...

You experience or witness behaviour that may place a child at risk.

A child tells you about something that has happened to them or to someone else.

You observe signs suggesting a child may be experiencing harm, abuse or neglect.

You become concerned about the conduct of a facilitator, mentor, volunteer, partner or visitor.

You identify an unsafe situation, practice or environment.

REPORT AS SOON AS POSSIBLE, THROUGH THESE CHANNELS

01 AMH Child Protection Officer / Safeguarding Focal Person

02 LeadAcy Programme Lead

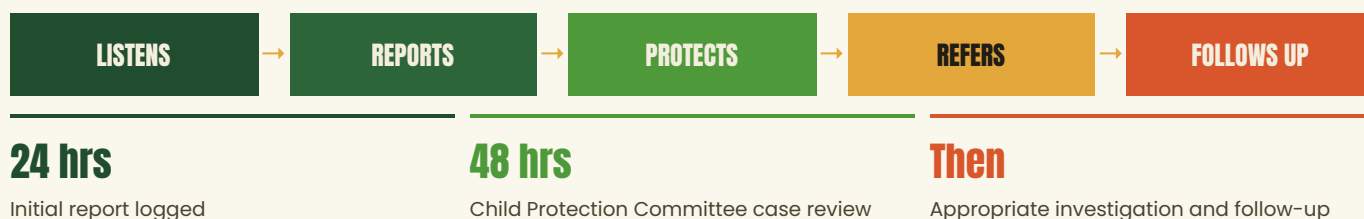
03 AMH Chief Executive Officer

04 AMH Child Protection Committee

05 Relevant external child protection or statutory authorities, where required

Go straight to an external authority if reporting internally could place a child at further risk, or if the concern involves AMH leadership. Another designated safeguarding contact may also be used.

WHEN A CONCERN IS RAISED



OUR SAFEGUARDING COMMITMENT

LEADACY IS A SPACE WHERE CHILDREN SHOULD FEEL SAFE TO LEARN, LEAD, SPEAK, PARTICIPATE AND BE HEARD.

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. Through creating safe environments, maintaining professional boundaries, recognising risks, speaking up about concerns and responding responsibly, we collectively contribute to a culture in which every child is protected, respected, heard and empowered to thrive.



CLOSING NOTE

LEADacy is designed to help children move from knowing themselves to understanding their communities, from understanding their communities to engaging with the world, and from having a voice to using that voice responsibly. Its goal is not simply to produce confident speakers or knowledgeable delegates. It is to cultivate young people who can think, listen, communicate, collaborate, negotiate, serve and act while remaining grounded in African identity, dignity and community.

———— *I AM BECAUSE WE ARE* ————